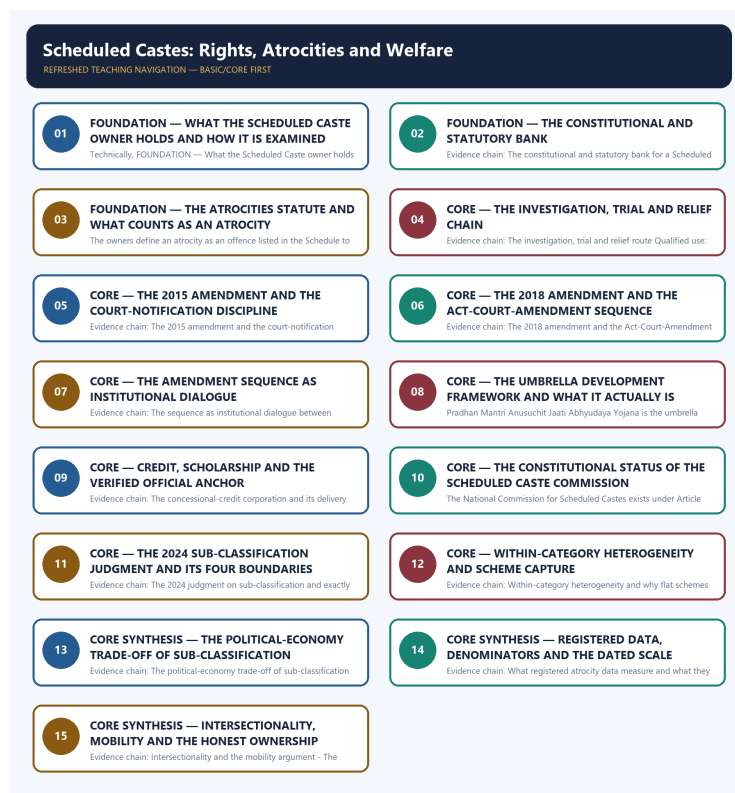


## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Scheduled Castes: Rights, Atrocities and Welfare - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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# Scheduled Castes: Rights, Atrocities and Welfare - Solved Practice Workbook

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

**Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?**

A. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. D. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for.

**Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian

evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

#### **Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?**

A. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. B. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. C. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a



violence statute alone understates its coverage. D. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its PYQ record...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.



### Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. C. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. D. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Answer: C. Explanation:** This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Demand decoding:** Treat “Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its...” as a category, right, authority, eligibility, implementation, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

#### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

#### Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course

correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the legal and measured category; separate entitlement from scheme, coverage from outcome and prohibition from implementation; eliminate the nearest group-homogenising, stale-data, denominator or jurisdiction distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents a familiar scheme, group label or headline statistic from being mistaken for an exact right, operative rule or proven outcome.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its...”, state why the closest distractor fails on category, authority, eligibility, denominator, causation, date or implementation status.

#### **Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?**

A. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. B. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. C. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting**

debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer?**

A. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. B. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer?

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. D. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer?

A. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. B. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly



one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. C. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. D. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer?**

A. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. B. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. C. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. D. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation,

Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The atrocities statute of 1989 as a special law?**

A. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. B. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. C. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. D. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under The atrocities statute of 1989 as a special law?

A. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. B. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. C. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. D. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The atrocities statute of 1989 as a special law?

A. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. B. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its



distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The atrocities statute of 1989 as a special law?**

A. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. B. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. C. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. D. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal**

law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q13. Which statement correctly identifies What counts as an atrocity and who may commit one?**

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. C. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. D. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under What counts as an atrocity and who may commit one?**

A. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. B. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion

such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. C. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. D. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What counts as an atrocity and who may commit one?**

A. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. B. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. C. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among**

the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What counts as an atrocity and who may commit one?**

A. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. B. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. C. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. D. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The investigation, trial and relief route?**

A. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. B. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report,



no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. C. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. D. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The investigation, trial and relief route?**

A. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. B. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. C. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the

framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The investigation, trial and relief route?**

A. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. B. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. C. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: C. Explanation:** The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.



## Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The investigation, trial and relief route?

A. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. B. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. C. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. D. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The 2015 amendment and the court-notification discipline?

A. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. B. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a

constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. C. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. D. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## **Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2015 amendment and the court-notification discipline?**

A. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. B. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. C. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2015 amendment and the court-notification discipline?**

A. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. B. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. C. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: C. Explanation:** The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

## Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2015 amendment and the court-notification discipline?

A. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. B. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The 2018 amendment and the Act-Court-Amendment sequence?

A. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. B. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so

the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. C. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2018 amendment and the Act-Court-Amendment sequence?**

A. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. B. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. C. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to



a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2018 amendment and the Act-Court-Amendment sequence?**

A. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. B. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. C. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. D. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2018 amendment and the Act-Court-Amendment sequence?

A. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. B. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. C. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. D. The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The sequence as institutional dialogue between legislature and judiciary?

A. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. B. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or

post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. C. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### **Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The sequence as institutional dialogue between legislature and judiciary?**

A. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. B. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of

Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### **Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The sequence as institutional dialogue between legislature and judiciary?**

A. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. B. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. C. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. D. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



### Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The sequence as institutional dialogue between legislature and judiciary?

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The umbrella development framework and what it actually is?

A. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. B. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. C. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026,



records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The umbrella development framework and what it actually is?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised

in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The umbrella development framework and what it actually is?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. C. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. D. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail.

**Answer: C. Explanation:** Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The umbrella development framework and what it actually is?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. C. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. D. Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The concessional-credit corporation and its delivery route?**

A. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. B. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to

advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### **Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The concessional-credit corporation and its delivery route?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. C. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. D. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans,**



micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The concessional-credit corporation and its delivery route?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. C. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. D. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The concessional-credit corporation and its delivery route?**

A. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the



empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. D. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The post-matriculation scholarship as a verified official anchor?**

A. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. B. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is

exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent.

**Answer: A. Explanation:** The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The post-matriculation scholarship as a verified official anchor?**

A. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. B. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. C. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. D. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The post-matriculation scholarship as a verified official anchor?**

A. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. D. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The post-matriculation scholarship as a verified official anchor?**

A. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. B. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect

rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. C. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. D. The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The commission for Scheduled Castes is a constitutional body?**

A. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. B. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. C. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. D. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided



on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under The commission for Scheduled Castes is a constitutional body?**

A. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. B. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. C. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. D. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



**Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The commission for Scheduled Castes is a constitutional body?**

A. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. B. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. C. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. D. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The commission for Scheduled Castes is a constitutional body?**

A. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary

official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. D. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The National Commission for Scheduled Castes exists under Article 338 of the Constitution and is therefore a constitutional body whose duties to investigate and monitor safeguards, to inquire into specific complaints and to advise on planning and socio-economic development are entrenched in the Constitution itself, which distinguishes it sharply from a statutory commission created by ordinary legislation such as the women's commission; the owners deliberately do not re-teach its composition and detailed mandate because that content belongs to the Polity commissions owner, and they require the cross-link to be stated rather than the material to be duplicated, so an answer here should use the status distinction and route the institutional detail. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The 2024 judgment on sub-classification and exactly what it decided?**

A. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. B. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. C. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. D. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional.

**Answer: A. Explanation: State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care,**

because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2024 judgment on sub-classification and exactly what it decided?**

A. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. B. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. C. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. D. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Answer: B. Explanation: State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2024 judgment on sub-classification and exactly what it decided?**

A. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for

each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. D. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Answer: C. Explanation: State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2024 judgment on sub-classification and exactly what it decided?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more.

**Answer: D. Explanation: State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care,**



because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The creamy-layer observations were separate opinions and not a rule?**

A. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. D. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The creamy-layer observations were separate opinions and not a rule?**

A. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. B. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for



other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The creamy-layer observations were separate opinions and not a rule?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. C. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. D. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must**

not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The creamy-layer observations were separate opinions and not a rule?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Within-category heterogeneity and why flat schemes may miss the worst off?**

A. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. B. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make

a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. C. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. D. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Within-category heterogeneity and why flat schemes may miss the worst off?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities**

are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Within-category heterogeneity and why flat schemes may miss the worst off?**

A. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. B. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. C. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Within-category heterogeneity and why flat schemes may miss the worst off?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument,



namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. D. The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The political-economy trade-off of sub-classification?**

A. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. B. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. C. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. D. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the



Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The political-economy trade-off of sub-classification?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The political-economy trade-off of sub-classification?

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. C. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The political-economy trade-off of sub-classification?

A. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity

special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. C. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. D. The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q65. Which statement correctly identifies What registered atrocity data measure and what they do not?**

A. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. B. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. C. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income,

assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under What registered atrocity data measure and what they do not?**

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. B. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. C. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the



**Answer: B. Explanation: The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What registered atrocity data measure and what they do not?**

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical**



### Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What registered atrocity data measure and what they do not?

A. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. D. The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The scale anchor and how to use it?

A. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper

II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. C. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The scale anchor and how to use it?**

A. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. B. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. C. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. D. The audited routing ledgers, which

cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### **Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The scale anchor and how to use it?**

A. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be**

silently applied to a later count without saying so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The scale anchor and how to use it?**

A. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. D. The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Intersectionality and the mobility argument?**

A. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. B. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward



classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. D. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### **Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Intersectionality and the mobility argument?**

A. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. B. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains



demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### **Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Intersectionality and the mobility argument?**

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. C. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. D. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Intersectionality and the mobility argument?

A. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. B. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Demand decoding:** Treat “Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ...” as a category, right, authority, eligibility, implementation, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

#### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?”.

#### Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:**

State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The constitutional and statutory bank for a Scheduled Caste answer? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The atrocities statute of 1989 as a special law? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ record is stated as zero?".

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the legal and measured category; separate entitlement from scheme, coverage from outcome and prohibition from implementation; eliminate the nearest group-homogenising, state-data, denominator or jurisdiction distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents a familiar scheme, group label or headline statistic from being mistaken for an exact right, operative rule or proven outcome.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its PYQ...", state why the closest distractor fails on category, authority, eligibility, denominator, causation, date or implementation status.

### Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. B. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve

seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. This topic owns the Scheduled Caste half of the protection-and-welfare argument, namely the special atrocities law with its amendment sequence, the umbrella development framework, the concessional-credit corporation, the post-matriculation scholarship route and the within-category targeting debate opened by the 2024 sub-classification judgment; its distinctive feature is the honesty of its examination record, because the audited routing ledgers route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and the nearest neighbouring demand, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, is routed by the ledger to the Polity commissions owner and is therefore not claimed here; reservation doctrine such as the ceiling and the creamy-layer rule for other backward classes is owned by the Polity special-provisions owner, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation question by the manual-scavenging owner.

**Answer: A. Explanation:** The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Demand decoding:** The directive answer requires a direct position on “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

### **Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?**

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. C. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. D. The owners record the law bank as Articles 14 to 17, 23, 46, 330 and 332 and 338, where Article 15 and Article 16 permit special provision and reservation, Article 17 abolishes untouchability and makes its practice an offence, Article 23 prohibits forced labour and trafficking, Article 46 directs the State to promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections and to protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation, Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the House of the People and in the State Assemblies, and Article 338 creates the national commission; the statutory layer is the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 with its special-court, relief and witness architecture, and the discipline is that an untouchability offence and an atrocity are separate statutory routes rather than synonyms.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

### Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?

A. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. B. The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective

demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. D. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.

**Answer: C. Explanation:** The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Demand decoding:** Treat "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated..." as a category, right, authority, eligibility, implementation, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?"

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?"

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the legal and measured category; separate entitlement from scheme, coverage from outcome and prohibition from implementation; eliminate the nearest group-homogenising, stale-data, denominator or jurisdiction distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents a familiar scheme, group label or headline statistic from being mistaken for an exact right, operative rule or proven outcome.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated...", state why the closest distractor fails on category, authority, eligibility, denominator, causation, date or implementation status.

### Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?

A. The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. B. The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. C. The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Answer: D. Explanation:** The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

**Demand decoding:** Treat “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?” as a category, right, authority, eligibility, implementation, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly? **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline

implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the legal and measured category; separate entitlement from scheme, coverage from outcome and prohibition from implementation; eliminate the nearest group-homogenising, stale-data, denominator or jurisdiction distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents a familiar scheme, group label or headline statistic from being mistaken for an exact right, operative rule or proven outcome.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The zero-direct-PYQ audit stated openly?”, state why the closest distractor fails on category, authority, eligibility, denominator, causation, date or implementation status.

## TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and that zero is reported openly rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card. The four audited ledgers consulted are the Mains routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025, and neither the Basic owner nor the Advanced owner for this topic carries a generated previous-year integration block, which is itself consistent with that zero. The nearest neighbouring demand is the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions, and the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes it to the Polity commissions owner, so no ownership is claimed over it here; the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands to the Polity owner, so none of those is claimed either. The Advanced owner records expressly that there is no direct recent Mains hit on Scheduled Caste atrocities and welfare and that the 2024 sub-classification judgment is a current anchor for a possible future demand, and this package adopts exactly that position: the judgment is taught as a current anchor and is not presented as evidence that a demand already exists. The practice in this package therefore consists of six original Mains questions with model solutions, each written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern, together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. Each model solution opens with its analytical claim so that the evidence which follows does argumentative rather than decorative work. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm that no question on this owner's subject matter is routed here; no question was invented from them, no marking scheme or page precision was imported and no official answer key is claimed for any question anywhere in this package.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal

limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.  
**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.  
**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.  
**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.  
**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.  
**Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in “TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.



## OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

### 9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-II Mains hit on SC atrocities/welfare. However, the Davinder Singh judgment is a current anchor that examiners may use in future questions on targeted welfare delivery or within-SC inequality.

### 10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-II Mains PYQ on SC atrocities/welfare. Davinder Singh is a current anchor for future questions. If asked about SC-welfare targeting, structure the answer around: (a) within-SC heterogeneity; (b) sub-classification permission; (c) PM-AJAY/NSFDC delivery; (d) political-economy trade-off.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Distinguish the legal-protection channel of Scheduled Caste policy from its welfare-delivery channel, and explain why a complete answer must use both. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** Protection and delivery answer different failures, so the distinction must be drawn by naming the statute and the procedural chain on one side and the sanction-driven scheme channels on the other, then showing that neither repairs the other's defect.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for.
- The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.
- Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components.
- The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.

**Qualified conclusion:** Protection and delivery answer different failures, so the distinction must be drawn by naming the statute and the procedural chain on one side and the sanction-driven scheme channels on the other, then showing that neither repairs the other's defect.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Distinguish the legal-protection channel of Scheduled Caste policy from its welfare-delivery...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction,

rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Protection and delivery answer different failures, so the distinction must be drawn by naming the statute and the procedural chain on one side and the sanction-driven scheme channels on the other, then showing that neither repairs the other's defect.

**Analytical body:**

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 is a special law providing enhanced penalties for caste-based offences committed against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, and the owners record its distinctive architecture as Special Courts for trial, victim-relief provisions and a presumption of the offence in certain circumstances; the reason the design matters in an answer is that the same physical act may be an ordinary offence under the general penal law and an atrocity under this Act, and it is the identity of the victim, the identity of the accused and the listed nature of the act that convert the first into the second, which is why a general law-and-order framing misses what the statute is for.

**Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.

**Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyudaya Yojana is the umbrella Scheduled Caste development framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and the owners record its three delivery channels as development of Scheduled Caste dominated villages under the model-village component, grants for approved district and State socio-economic development projects, and hostel support in higher educational institutions; the critical qualification is that these are project and sanction channels driven by State proposals and annual approvals rather than an automatic individual benefit, so it is an error both to describe the framework as a personal scholarship or loan entitlement and to treat every ministry scheme for Scheduled Castes as one of its components. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** Protection and delivery answer different failures, so the distinction must be drawn by naming the statute and the procedural chain on one side and the sanction-driven scheme channels on the other, then showing that neither repairs the other's defect.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Distinguish the legal-protection channel of Scheduled Caste policy from its welfare-delivery...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Examine what the 2015 and 2018 amendments to the atrocities statute changed, and what they could not change. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** The amendments changed the offence list, the court architecture and the arrest and bail position, so the examination must state each change precisely and then locate the residual problem in notification, registration and witness protection rather than in the text.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.
- The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one.
- The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation.
- The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying

across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

**Qualified conclusion:** The amendments changed the offence list, the court architecture and the arrest and bail position, so the examination must state each change precisely and then locate the residual problem in notification, registration and witness protection rather than in the text.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine what the 2015 and 2018 amendments to the atrocities statute changed, and what they...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The amendments changed the offence list, the court architecture and the arrest and bail position, so the examination must state each change precisely and then locate the residual problem in notification, registration and witness protection rather than in the text.

**Analytical body:**

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the sequence with care. A 2018 ruling of the Supreme Court diluted arrest and anticipatory-bail protection under the Act; Parliament responded by inserting Section 18A, under which no preliminary inquiry is required for the registration of a first information report, no approval is required for arrest and the statutory bar on anticipatory bail is restored notwithstanding that ruling; the constitutional challenge to the amendment was then decided in Prathvi Raj Chauhan in 2020, which upheld Section 18A while preserving an exceptional power in a constitutional court to intervene where the complaint discloses no prima facie case; the recurring trap is to say the 2018 amendment implemented a judicial direction when it in fact overrode one. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners treat the 1989 Act, the 2018 ruling and the 2018 amendment as a textbook instance of the legislature responding to a judicial reading by amending the law, and they invite the cross-link to the Polity owner for the doctrine; the analytical shape is that the Court read a safeguard against misuse into a statute, Parliament restored the original stringency by express provision, and the Court then tested the restored provision and upheld it while retaining a narrow constitutional escape valve, so the episode ends in an equilibrium rather than in a victory for either branch; an answer that uses it must state all three steps, because reciting only the amendment converts a dialogue into a confrontation. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read

together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The amendments changed the offence list, the court architecture and the arrest and bail position, so the examination must state each change precisely and then locate the residual problem in notification, registration and witness protection rather than in the text.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Examine what the 2015 and 2018 amendments to the atrocities statute changed, and what they...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

### ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Critically examine the claim that legal protection alone can secure justice for Scheduled Castes. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** Law changes the price of an act without changing the conditions that produce it, so the critical examination must run the procedural chain, test it against what registered data can and cannot show, and close on the entry and conversion sides of mobility.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage.
- The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.
- The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality



and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

- The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure.

**Qualified conclusion:** Law changes the price of an act without changing the conditions that produce it, so the critical examination must run the procedural chain, test it against what registered data can and cannot show, and close on the entry and conversion sides of mobility.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on “Critically examine the claim that legal protection alone can secure justice for Scheduled...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Law changes the price of an act without changing the conditions that produce it, so the critical examination must run the procedural chain, test it against what registered data can and cannot show, and close on the entry and conversion sides of mobility.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define an atrocity as an offence listed in the Schedule to the Act, and they name assault, wrongful dispossession, forced labour, sexual exploitation and public humiliation among the listed heads, committed against a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe person by a person who is not a member of those categories; the 2015 amendment expanded the list with new offences including garlanding with footwear and preventing entry to public places, so the offence set is not confined to physical violence and expressly reaches social and economic exclusion such as boycott, which is why an answer that treats the Act as a violence statute alone understates its coverage. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional

variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** Law changes the price of an act without changing the conditions that produce it, so the critical examination must run the procedural chain, test it against what registered data can and cannot show, and close on the entry and conversion sides of mobility.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Critically examine the claim that legal protection alone can secure justice for Scheduled...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Assess the implications of the 2024 judgment permitting sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for welfare targeting. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** The judgment supplies permission rather than a policy, so the assessment must state the holding and its four boundaries, connect within-category heterogeneity to the delivery channels and hold opportunity, fragmentation risk and the evidence requirement together.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more.
- The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent.

- The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner.
- The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional.

**Qualified conclusion:** The judgment supplies permission rather than a policy, so the assessment must state the holding and its four boundaries, connect within-category heterogeneity to the delivery channels and hold opportunity, fragmentation risk and the evidence requirement together.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the implications of the 2024 judgment permitting sub-classification within the...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The judgment supplies permission rather than a policy, so the assessment must state the holding and its four boundaries, connect within-category heterogeneity to the delivery channels and hold opportunity, fragmentation risk and the evidence requirement together.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** State of Punjab against Davinder Singh, decided on 1 August 2024 by a seven-judge Constitution Bench by a majority of six to one, held that sub-classification within the Scheduled Castes for the purpose of reservation is constitutionally permissible where it is supported by data, and it overruled the earlier decision in E.V. Chinnaiah; the owners then set the boundary of the holding with unusual care, because the judgment does not alter the Presidential List of Scheduled Castes, does not itself allot any sub-quota to any group and does not direct any State to sub-classify, so what it grants is constitutional permission for an evidence-based State measure and nothing more. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that observations about applying a creamy-layer style filter to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes appeared in separate opinions in the 2024 judgment and were not part of the binding holding, and that no general creamy-layer exclusion for those categories has been legislated; the discipline that follows is that the existing creamy-layer rule for other backward classes must not be transplanted in an answer, and that a candidate who writes that the Supreme Court has introduced a creamy layer for the Scheduled Castes has converted an obiter discussion into a legislated rule, which is exactly the status error this folder exists to prevent. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners insist that the Scheduled Castes are not a monolithic category, because some sub-castes face substantially greater disadvantage than others and manual-scavenging communities are named as a boundary case carrying stigma and occupational hazard beyond general Scheduled Caste disadvantage; the policy consequence is that a scheme designed for the category as a whole may be

captured disproportionately by the relatively better-placed sub-groups, so the model-village, hostel and credit channels can be fully implemented and still leave the worst-off communities untouched, and the sanitation-worker rehabilitation route belongs to the manual-scavenging owner. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out three considerations that any sub-classification answer must hold together: the opportunity, which is that sub-classification addresses within-category inequality and prevents relatively advanced sub-castes from capturing a disproportionate share of benefits; the risk, which is that it may fragment Scheduled Caste political unity and weaken collective bargaining power while State-level politics exploits sub-caste divisions for electoral purposes; and the empirical requirement, which is that any classification must be justified by backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, failing which it is arbitrary and legally vulnerable; the owners add that the judgment permits but does not mandate the measure, so a State's inaction is not itself unconstitutional. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** The judgment supplies permission rather than a policy, so the assessment must state the holding and its four boundaries, connect within-category heterogeneity to the delivery channels and hold opportunity, fragmentation risk and the evidence requirement together.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Assess the implications of the 2024 judgment permitting sub-classification within the...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Analyse why registered atrocity data are an unreliable measure of the incidence of caste-based violence, and what would improve the evidence base. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** Registration is an administrative event and not an epidemiological one, so the analysis must separate registration, investigation, prosecution and conviction, explain what suppresses each, and propose measures that are specific to the suppressed stage.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator.

- The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so.
- The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.
- The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question.

**Qualified conclusion:** Registration is an administrative event and not an epidemiological one, so the analysis must separate registration, investigation, prosecution and conviction, explain what suppresses each, and propose measures that are specific to the suppressed stage.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on "Analyse why registered atrocity data are an unreliable measure of the incidence of caste-...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Registration is an administrative event and not an epidemiological one, so the analysis must separate registration, investigation, prosecution and conviction, explain what suppresses each, and propose measures that are specific to the suppressed stage.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Crime Records Bureau publishes registered atrocity cases under the Act in its annual crime report, and the owners record it as the primary official source while stating its limits explicitly: it counts cases that entered the system, so a rise may reflect rising victimisation, improving reporting or both, and under-reporting driven by social pressure, fear of retaliation and police reluctance depresses registration, with registration practice varying across States; the owners add that a conviction figure must be read together with pendency, investigation quality and witness vulnerability, so a bare conviction rate is not evidence about the incidence of atrocity, and any current figure must be cited with its year and its denominator. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners carry one dated scale anchor, namely that the Scheduled Castes formed 16.6 per cent of India's population in the 2011 Census, and they attach the instruction that current atrocity data be used only with the year and denominator attached; the analytical use of a population share is to convert an absolute count into a rate and to make a representation claim about seats, services or budget shares meaningful, and its limit is that a share measured in 2011 is a dated denominator which must not be silently applied to a later count without saying so. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.



3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners set out the procedural chain as registration of a first information report for a listed atrocity offence, investigation by an officer of the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or above, trial before a State-notified Special Court with a Special Public Prosecutor, and victim relief in the form of monetary compensation, shelter and travel expenses in accordance with the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Rules, 1995 as amended; the analytical value of setting out the chain in this order is that a failure can be located at exactly one joint, so an answer can say whether the defect is registration, investigation rank, court capacity, prosecutor quality or the payment of relief rather than asserting that the Act does not work.

**Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2015 amendment expanded the list of atrocity offences, strengthened the rights of victims and witnesses and created the Special and Exclusive Special Court architecture, and the owners attach a precise caution to that architecture: such courts are notified by States under the conditions the Act lays down and with the concurrence of the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court, so it must not be stated that an Exclusive Special Court automatically exists in every district; the examinable consequence is that court availability is a State-specific fact to be verified rather than a national entitlement to be assumed, and pendency in atrocity trials is therefore partly a notification and staffing question. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** Registration is an administrative event and not an epidemiological one, so the analysis must separate registration, investigation, prosecution and conviction, explain what suppresses each, and propose measures that are specific to the suppressed stage.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Analyse why registered atrocity data are an unreliable measure of the incidence of caste-...", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Evaluate the proposition that Scheduled Caste policy has succeeded at widening entry and failed at securing conversion. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** Entry instruments and conversion barriers are different objects, so the evaluation must name the entry instruments including the education and credit routes, name the conversion barriers of discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence, and close with a graded verdict rather than a uniform one.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary

stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted.

- The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so.
- The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure.
- The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists.

**Qualified conclusion:** Entry instruments and conversion barriers are different objects, so the evaluation must name the entry instruments including the education and credit routes, name the conversion barriers of discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence, and close with a graded verdict rather than a uniform one.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the proposition that Scheduled Caste policy has succeeded at widening entry and...", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Entry instruments and conversion barriers are different objects, so the evaluation must name the entry instruments including the education and credit routes, name the conversion barriers of discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence, and close with a graded verdict rather than a uniform one.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment's own scheme page for the post-matric scholarship for students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, read on 2 September 2026, records that the objective of the scheme is to appreciably increase the gross enrolment ratio of Scheduled Caste students in higher education with a focus on those from the poorest households by providing financial assistance at the post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education; the same page records that the scholarships are available for studies in India only, that awardees are selected by the State Government or Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs according to the domicile terms decided by that State, that the scheme applies both to current beneficiaries and to fresh admissions, and that the complete guidelines were revised in March 2021 and are published on that page; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no coverage, disbursement or beneficiary count is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional

duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation is a Government of India company under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which provides concessional credit to Scheduled Caste beneficiaries, and the owners record its instruments as term loans, micro-credit and skill-development finance delivered through State channelising agencies rather than directly to a borrower; the reason the delivery route is examinable is that it makes the corporation's reach a function of the capacity and the appetite of the State agency in each State, so credit access is uneven for reasons that lie outside the corporation's own design, and an answer about economic mobility must say so. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record two analytical claims that turn a protection answer into a justice answer. First, Dalit women face caste discrimination, gender-based violence and economic dependence at the same time, so an intersectional case cannot be resolved by an atrocity remedy alone or by a gender remedy alone. Second, mobility has an entry side and a conversion side: reservation, scholarships and credit widen entry, while discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence constrain the conversion of entry into income, assets and standing; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must say which side it operates on, because an entry instrument does not repair a conversion failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and that absence is reported here rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card; the neighbouring 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed to the Polity commissions owner, the tribal demands are routed to the Indian Society and Modern History owners, and the Scheduled Area and Fifth Schedule objective demands are routed to the Polity owner, so none of them is claimed here; the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard, and the 2024 sub-classification judgment is treated as a current anchor for a future demand rather than as evidence that a demand already exists. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

**Counter-position / limit:** A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

**Qualified conclusion:** Entry instruments and conversion barriers are different objects, so the evaluation must name the entry instruments including the education and credit routes, name the conversion barriers of discrimination, landlessness, occupational segregation and violence, and close with a graded verdict rather than a uniform one.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Evaluate the proposition that Scheduled Caste policy has succeeded at widening entry and...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.